

Others had no problem sharing their fond memories of those days: the conventions where they never saw or heard of any illegal or suspect activities. Instead, these women enjoyed a room full of couponing comrades, a good lunch, some door prizes, and a frenzy of trading forms and coupons. Evidently, there were two different types of conventions being held: those that included questionable activities and those of a more innocent nature, designed for legitimate trading and fun.

A former refunder from Washington, who wished to remain anonymous, wrote:

*A friend and I held a refunding convention in the Washington area during the spring or summer of 1975. Most people who attended were just regular folks who did the allowable number of submissions for each refund. There were a lot more refunds back then. The other types of refunders showed up too. My friend and I saw two people sitting across a table from each other. Each had a tall stack of complete deals in front of them. They were both candid that they used multiple names and addresses and made over 1000 dollars per month each in refunds doing so. Another woman told us that she had her home address set up as an apartment building with twenty-four apartments so that she could do multiples of each refund. We met a woman whose husband worked in an auto shop so she obtained lots of oil and oil-filter UPCs and auto rebate forms. She bought a cash register so she could make her own receipts. On that day she had 300 oil filter complete deals available to sell or trade for. The other "high rollers" present specialized in alcohol deals. They would obtain empty liquor bottles from recycle facilities and make up complete deals creating their own cash register tapes.*